FROM AI THAT SUGGESTS TO AI THAT DOES

GitHub Agentic Workflows

Describe the task

Keep documentation aligned with code.

Review the result

The agent proposes; a person decides what merges.

> A controlled path from stale docs to a reviewed pull request.

01 / THE PROBLEM

Shipping faster quietly creates documentation debt

56.5%

of 12,374 developers say **outdated information** makes it hard to get the context they need.

My earlier attempt

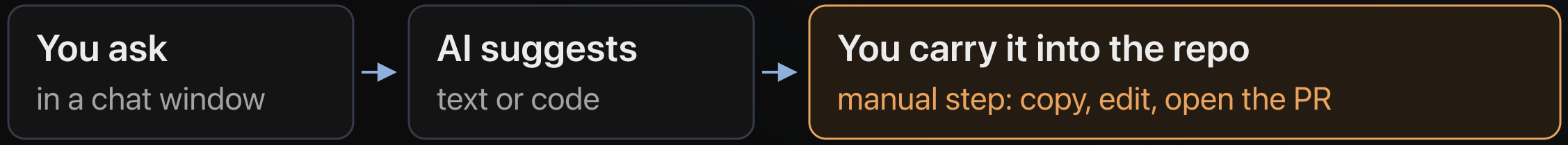
It tackled part of the problem.
TODO: the tool, what it solved, and the gap it left.

Industry survey, not our repositories · our own drift is not yet measured.

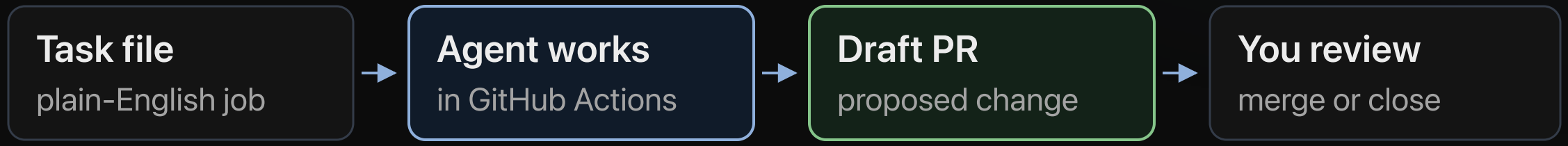
02 / THE SOLUTION

Agents move people from carrying changes to reviewing them

AI ASSISTANCE



AGENTIC WORKFLOW



Illustrative comparison.

03 / THE REAL EXAMPLE

Good agent output is a diff you can judge at a glance

PUBLIC EXAMPLE · github/gh-aw #8716 · merged 3 Jan 2026

BEFORE · UNWANTED TOC ENTRY

```
<h3 id="error-modal-title">
  Error Copying File
</h3>
```

AFTER · ACCESSIBLE MODAL LABEL

```
<div role="heading" aria-level="3"
     class="error-modal-title">
  Error Copying File
</div>
```

> A modal heading was leaking into the page navigation.

Diff simplified · Copilot follow-up from a docs-testing chain · not our pilot or an Update Docs run.

Guardrails live in reviewable config, not the model

```
---
on:
  push:
    branches: [main]
permissions: read-all
safe-outputs:
  create-pull-request:
    draft: true
---
# Update Docs
Ensure every code-level change is
mirrored by clear, accurate, and
stylistically consistent documentation.
```

Shift · `on:`
Every push to main

Access badge · `permissions`
Read-only

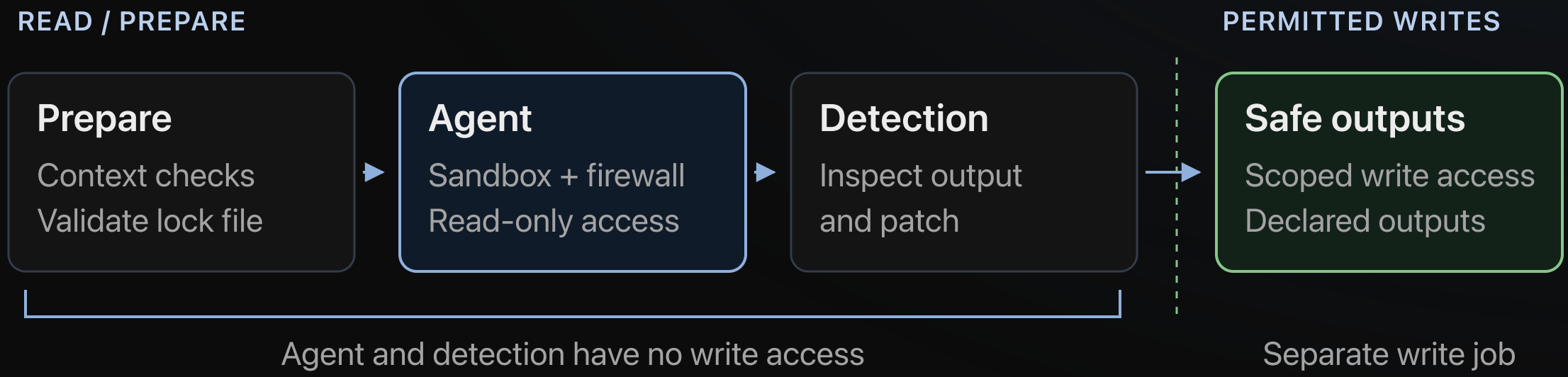
Outbox · `safe-outputs`
Draft pull requests only

Job description · Markdown body
Plain-English instructions

Real file, trimmed · githubnext/agentics workflows/update-docs.md · PR policy

05 / THE RUN

Safety is designed in, not left to the model



> Detection checks the output first; a person still reviews every draft PR.

Layers of control, not a guarantee.

06 / COST

Price each run in AI credits and reviewer minutes

Set limits

1,000 AIC per run
≈ $10 estimated

Documented default, not a pilot target.

Inspect the run

`gh aw logs`
Usage across runs

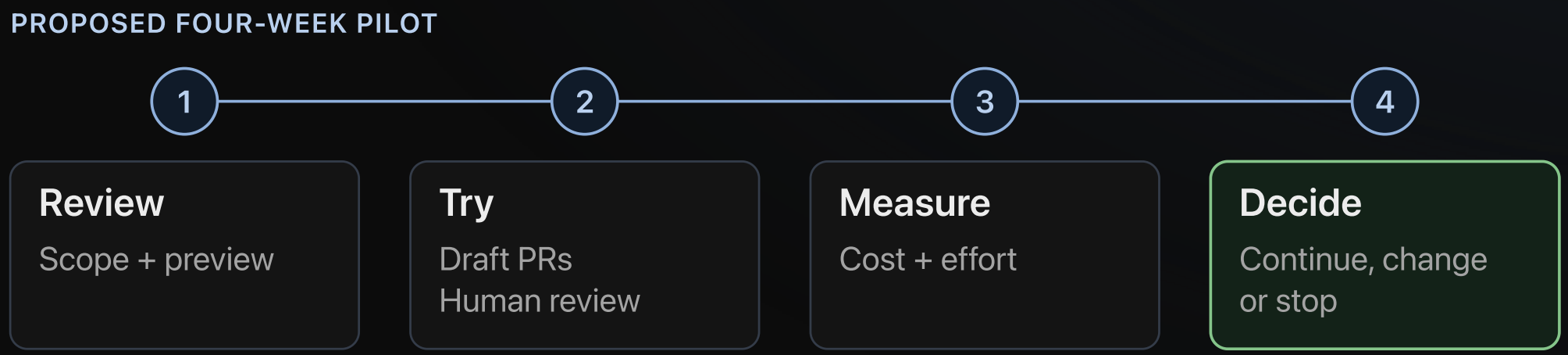
`gh aw audit <run-id>`
Tools, tokens and estimated cost

1 AIC = $0.01 estimated inference cost. Billing may differ; Actions minutes and detection also cost.

TODO · Agree pilot limits; measure cost per run and review time.

07 / THE PILOT

Four weeks turns opinion into evidence



Agree the baseline and success criteria before week one.

> Review accepted changes, reviewer effort and total cost together.

Week 1 runs with `staged: true` : writes are skipped, the run still costs.

08 / THE DECISION

The ask is small, capped and reversible

PROPOSED SCOPE

Documentation updates only

Candidate: `githubnext/agentics workflows/update-docs.md`

Draft PRs; a person decides what merges.

Pilot repository + owner

TODO: name both

Per-run + total pilot budget

TODO: agree explicit limits

Week-four success thresholds

TODO: set before starting

Pause on unsafe output or a breached limit.

APPENDIX 1 / COMPILATION

Compilation turns that file into an Actions workflow

1 · Author

Markdown task
and frontmatter

2 · Compile

`gh aw compile`
Generated `.lock.yml`

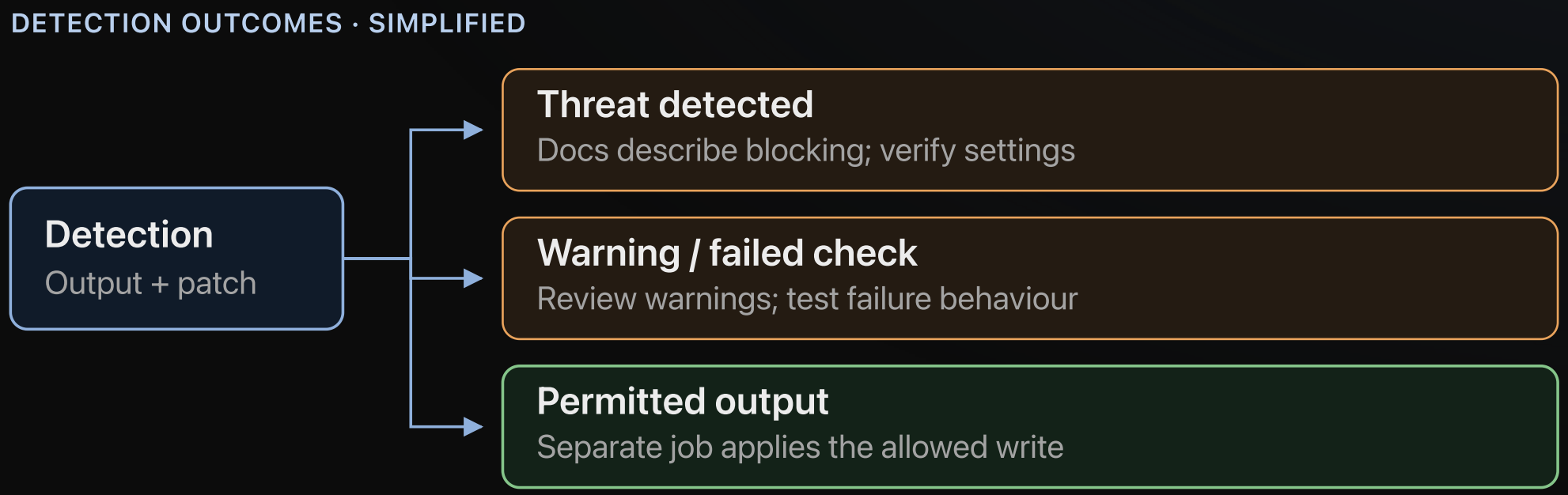
3 · Publish

Commit both files
Run in GitHub Actions

> Compilation validates configuration and pins Actions to commit SHAs.

APPENDIX 2 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

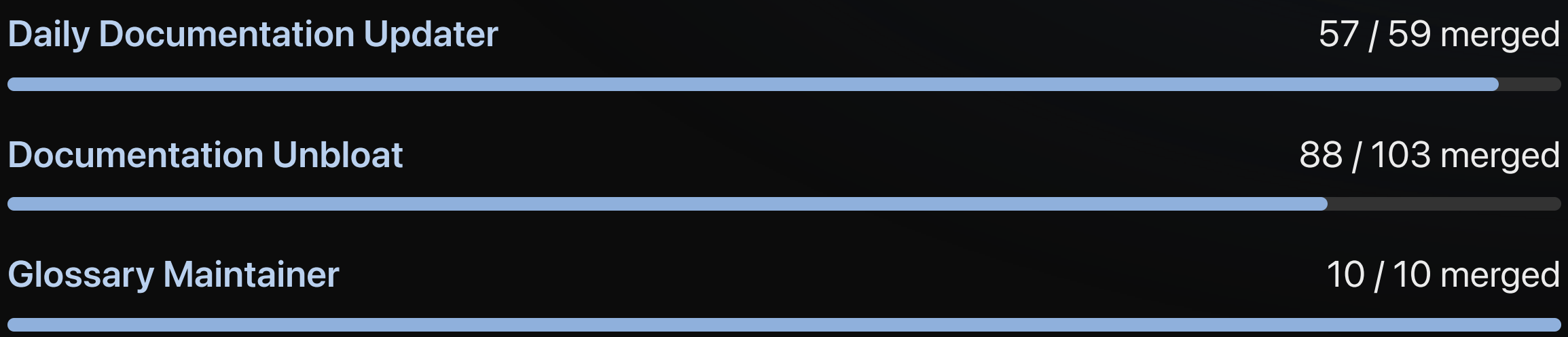
Detection adds a review gate, not a safety guarantee



Failure behaviour is disputed in the docs; test it with explicit settings before relying on it.

APPENDIX 3 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

GitHub reports strong results for selected docs workflows



GitHub report · 13 Jan 2026 · selected small samples, not a forecast for our pilot.

APPENDIX 4 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

Use agents where interpretation adds value

Good pilot candidate

Compare code with documentation.

Propose a small, reviewable correction.

Keep predictable work in CI

Build, test and release steps.

Use deterministic tools when they solve the task.

TODO · Agree which tasks stay with a person and our current autonomy level.

APPENDIX 5 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

Start with one workflow from the example collection

Example collection

TODO: repository URL
TODO: workflow file
TODO: recommended first task

Review before adding

Instructions and scope
Permissions and network
Outputs and budget

```
gh aw add-wizard owner/repo/workflow
```

Command template · replace it with the confirmed workflow reference.

APPENDIX 6 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

A trial can run in a temporary private repository

Select

Choose the reviewed workflow file.

Trial

```
gh aw trial <workflow>
```

Temporary private repo by default.

Inspect

Read the results before choosing the next step.

> TrialOps is experimental.

Isolation changes where the workflow runs; it does not make the run free or risk-free.

APPENDIX 7 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

Staged mode previews safe outputs before they are applied

```
safe-outputs:
  staged: true
  create-pull-request:
    draft: true
```

Compile and publish
Commit the Markdown and lock file.

Run and inspect
Read the Actions step summary.

Then decide
Enable draft PRs only after review.

> Staged safe-output writes are skipped; the workflow still runs.

APPENDIX 8 / DETAILS FOR QUESTIONS

The technical claims are grounded in GitHub's documentation

Public preview since 11 Jun 2026

Product and controls

Official changelog
Architecture and threat detection
PR policy and staged mode

Operating and measuring

CLI and schedule syntax
Cost management
Reported documentation results

Unresolved conflicts · daily AI-credit cap default · whether a failed detection run blocks safe outputs

Technical fact check: 17 Oct 2026. Sources are linked on the relevant slides and in speaker notes.

Public-preview changelog · Official docs